STARFIELD SKILLS

Skills are the primary progression element of *Starfield* and represent the capabilities of the Spacefarer. New Skills can be unlocked by leveling up, and unlocked Skills can be improved by using them to complete challenges and increase their rank. Some Skills are prerequisites for researching and crafting certain items.[1][2]

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Overview

Skills are grouped into five categories: Physical, Social, Combat, Science, and Tech. Each Skill category is divided into four tiers: Novice, Advanced, Expert, and Master.[1]

The Spacefarer begins with three different Novice Skills unlocked as determined by their chosen Background. Additional Skills can be unlocked by purchasing them with Skill Points, which are earned by leveling up. Higher-tier Skills require that a certain amount of Skill Points be invested in a particular category before they become available. For example, Expert Physical Skills cannot be purchased until a minimum of 10 Skill Points have been invested across Novice and Advanced Physical Skills (with at least 4 points in Novice skills before accessing Advanced).[1][2]

A newly-unlocked Skill begins at Rank 1. By completing associated challenges, a Skill can be ranked up three additional times to Rank 4 to maximize its effectiveness.[1] The Skill challenges will only track progress toward the next rank; for example, Security Rank 2 requires you to pick 5 locks, but you will not make progress until you purchase Security Rank 1.

List of Skills

Physical

Skill Tier	Skills
Novice	Boxing · Fitness · Stealth · Weight Lifting · Wellness
Advanced	Energy Weapon Dissipation · Environmental Conditioning · Gymnastics · Nutrition · Pain Tolerance

Expert	Cellular Regeneration · Decontamination · Martial Arts
Master	Concealment · Neurostrikes · Rejuvenation

Social

Skill Tier	Skills
Novice	Commerce · Gastronomy · Persuasion · Scavenging · Theft
Advanced	Deception · Diplomacy · Intimidation · Negotiation · Isolation
Expert	Instigation · Leadership · Outpost Management
Master	Manipulation · Ship Command · Xenosociology

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Combat

Skill Tier	Skills
Novice	Ballistics · Dueling · Lasers · Pistol Certification · Shotgun Certification
Advanced	Demolitions · Heavy Weapon Certification · Incapacitation · Rifle Certification

Expert	Marksmanship · Particle Beams · Rapid Reloading · Sniper Certification · Targeting
Master	Armor Penetration · Crippling · Sharpshooting

Science

Skill Tier	**Skills**
Novice	Astrodynamics · Geology · Medicine · Research Methods · Surveying
Advanced	Botany · Scanning · Spacesuit Design · Weapon Engineering · Zoology
Expert	Astrophysics · Chemistry · Outpost Engineering
Master	Aneutronic Fusion · Planetary Habitation · Special Projects

Tech

Skill Tier	**Skills**
Novice	Ballistic Weapon Systems · Boost Pack Training · Piloting · Security · Targeting Control Systems
Advanced	Energy Weapon Systems · Engine Systems · Payloads · Shield Systems

Expert	Missile Weapon Systems · Particle Beam Weapon Systems · Robotics · Starship Design · Starship Engineering
Master	Automated Weapon Systems · Boost Assault Training · EM Weapon Systems

Crew Skills

The skills of crew members function differently than the Spacefarer's skills.[3][4] The bonuses provided by each possible crew member's skills are not clearly listed in the game itself. However, the skills of crew members appear to stack with the Spacefarer's skills, even when the Spacefarer has maxed out a particular skill.

Skill	**Skill Type**	**Assignment Type**	**Bonus Provided**	**Associated Crew**
Aneutronic Fusion	Science	Ship	Grants additional reactor power	Andromeda Kepler, Vasco, Sahima Ka'dic
Astrodynamics	Science	Ship	Reduces fuel costs for grav jumps	Sarah Morgan,
Ballistic Weapon Systems	Tech	Ship	Increases the damage of ballistic ship weapons	Gideon Aker

Ballistics	Combat	Follower	Indicates the follower is more effective with ballistic firearms	Marika Boros
Botany	Science	Follower	The follower will regularly offer gifts of plants to the player	Sarah Morgan
Chemistry	Science	???		Dani Garcia
Concealment	Physical	???		Adoring Fan
Demolitions	Combat	Follower	Indicates the follower is more effective with grenades	Lin
EM Weapon Systems	Tech	Ship	Increases the damage of EM ship weapons	Vasco, Moara Otero, Sahima Ka'dic
Energy Weapon Systems	Tech	Ship	Increases the damage of energy ship weapons	Andreja
Gastronomy	Social	Follower	The follower will regularly offer gifts of	Barrett

			food items to the player	
Geology	Science	Follower	The follower will regularly offer gifts of minerals to the player	Heller, Sam Coe
Lasers	Combat	Follower	Indicates the follower is more effective with laser weapons	Sarah Morgan
Leadership	Social	Ship or Outpost	Crew member does not add to the crew total at their assignment location	Sarah Morgan
Medicine	Science	Follower	The follower will regularly offer gifts of medicinal items to the player	Rosie Tannehill
Missile Weapon Systems	Tech	Ship	Increases the damage of ship missiles	Gideon Aker
Outpost Engineering	Science	Outpost		Andromeda Kepler, Heller, Rafael Aguerro

Outpost Management	Social	Outpost		Lin, Rafael Aguerro
Particle Beam Weapon Systems	Tech	Ship	Increases the damage of ship particle beams	Barrett, Marika Boros
Payloads	Tech	Ship	Increases ship's cargo capacity	Sam Coe, Tane Salavea
Piloting	Tech	Ship	Increases ship's top speed	Amelia Earhart, Andromeda Kepler, Sam Coe
Pistol Certification	Combat	Follower	Indicates the follower is more effective with pistols	Tane Salavea
Rifle Certification	Combat	Follower	Indicates the follower is more effective with rifles	Amelia Earhart, Sam Coe
Robotics	Tech	???		Barrett
Scavenging	Social	???		Adoring Fan
Shield Systems	Tech	Ship	Increases ship's shield capacity	Omari Hassan, Vasco

Shotgun Certification	Combat	Follower	Indicates the follower is more effective with shotguns	Marika Boros
Sniper Certification	Combat	Follower	Indicates the follower is more effective with scoped firearms	Sahima Ka’dic
Starship Engineering	Tech	Ship	Increases ship repair speed	Barrett, Omari Hassan, Rafael Aguerro
Stealth	Physical	???		Andreja, Tane Salavea
Theft	Social	Follower	The follower will regularly offer gifts of credits to the player	Andreja
Weight Lifting	Physical	Follower	Increases the follower's carrying capacity	Adoring Fan
Wellness	Physical	???		Rosie Tannehill

Persuasion

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Persuasion is a Novice Social Skill[1] that increases the Spacefarer's ability to pass speech checks during dialogue.

Persuasion is a Starting Skill for the Diplomat, Industrialist, Sculptor, and Space Scoundrel backgrounds.

Ranks

Rank	Challenge	Bonuses
1	Succeed in 3 speech challenges.	10% increased chance of success when persuading someone.
2	Succeed in 5 speech challenges.	20% increased chance of success when persuading someone.
3	Succeed in 10 speech challenges.	30% increased chance of success when persuading someone.
4	N/A	50% increased chance of success when persuading someone.

Progression and Strategy

Persuasion can be difficult to level, as there aren't any direct ways to gain Persuasion opportunities. Due to this, it is advisable for players interested in creating a "smooth talker" character to get Persuasion early in the game.

Persuasion is a highly situational skill, but very useful within those situations. It isn't an alternative to combat, but can be used to gain access and advantages in several situations. Persuasion is rarely the only way to do something, but it is often the path of least resistance to completing quest objectives.

One mission tree early on, as a way for persuasion checks to get accumulated and accomplished is to do the Media Sponge missionline through Mitch Benjamin, found on Cydonia in the Sol system. The missions are 30 in total, providing enough for full upgrading of persuasion.

Ship Command

Ship Control is a Master Social Skill. It increases the crew capacity of the player's ships.

Ranks

Rank	Challenge	Bonuses
1	Destroy or board 5 ships with a crew of two or more.	You can have up to four active crew members.
2	Destroy or board 25 ships with a crew of four or more.	You can have up to five active crew members.
3	Destroy or board 50 ships with a crew of six or more.	You can have up to six active crew members.

4	N/A	You can have up to eight active crew members.

Sharpshooting

Sharpshooting is a Master Combat Skill.[1]

Ranks

Rank	Challenge	Bonuses
1	Deal 50 ranged critical hits.	Increase headshot critical damage by 50% with ranged weapons.
2	Deal 125 ranged critical hits.	Increase critical damage to enemy legs by 50% with ranged weapons.
3	Deal 250 ranged critical hits.	Increase all critical damage to enemies by 50% with ranged weapons.
4	N/A	Ranged critical hit kills increase your critical hit chance with all ranged weapons by 25% for 20 seconds.

Planetary Habitation

Planetary Habitation is a Master Science Skill. It is used to increase the player's flexibility in building Outposts.

Ranks

Rank	Challenge	Bonuses
1	Build habitable outposts on 3 different planets.	You can build outposts on planets with extreme temperatures (Deep Freeze and Inferno). Increase the maximum number of Outposts you can build by 4.
2	Build habitable outposts on 5 different planets.	You can build outposts on planets with extreme pressure. Increase the maximum number of Outposts you can build by 8.
3	Build habitable outposts on 10 different planets.	You can build outposts on planets with toxic or corrosive atmospheres. Increase the maximum number of Outposts you can build by 12.
4	N/A	You can build outposts on planets with extreme gravity. Increase the maximum number of Outposts you can build by 16.

Progression and Strategy

As placing outposts is free, building a bunch of bare minimum outposts is easy and inexpensive, though it may be a bit time consuming. Planetary Habitation has two main uses:

- Building lots of Outposts
- Building Outposts on dangerous hellscape planets

Outposts can serve many purposes. Being able to build a ton of them or building them anywhere can serve several purposes. However, most of the other outpost skills are more impactful. Outposts often require significant investment before they are useful, and building a bunch of underdeveloped Outposts is a bit counter-intuitive. Unless there is a hostile planet where the player really wants to build an Outpost, they probably have better choices.